

Introduction

Since the time primordial man first picked up a rock and thwacked a scurrying rodent on its head to fix his dinner, mankind has always been inventing things. Improvising, innovating, crafting tools out of almost nothing to overcome the many difficulties of day-to-day life. Whether it was the rudimentary spear crafted by sharpening the end of a stick or much later a simple chair, inventions have shaped our very evolution.

Before you get worried we'll assure you we've not gone that far back in time in this Fast Track. Being Digit, to come up with mankind's top 100 inventions we've (more or less) stuck to technology or inventions that enabled great leaps in technology. The inventions we've covered span core-science aeronautics, biology, physics, medicine, automobiles, electronics and of course technology. We've avoided things like "fire" or "the wheel" because quite frankly no one really knows how the former was discovered (not invented) and who invented the latter. How did we come up with this list? Well the five-member team of self-proclaimed experts (read: Digit old hats) and their apprentices (read: starry-eyed interns) convened and fought tooth and nail over which inventions have had the biggest impact on all the spheres of our day-to-day life. Extensive lists were drawn up and voted upon. Finally after discarding perhaps many items, we finally settled on a list of 100 that we more or less agreed upon. Of course, you'll come across unlikely contenders such as "The Electric

CREDITS

The people behind this book

EDITORIAL

Executive Editor

Robert Sovereign-Smith

Writers

Avinash Kothuri
Perzen Patel
Priyanka Mathur
Nicole Anklesaria
Jayesh Shinde
Anirudh Regidi
Siddharth Parwatay
Vaibhav Kaushal

Features Editor

Siddharth Parwatay

Contributor

Copy Editor: Infancia
Cardozo

DESIGN

Sr. Creative Director

Jayan K Narayanan

Sr. Art Director

Anil VK

Asst. Art Directors

Atul Deshmukh
Anil T

Sr. Visualisers

Manav Sachdev
Shokeen Saifi

Visualiser

Baiju NV

Consulting Designer

Vijay Padaya